

Sunday, 5 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 28° 18°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 25° 16°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 21° 16°	GLASGOW Drizzle 16° 14°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

England's World Cup last-16 match against Mexico will kick off at 1am Monday morning, after FIFA reversed a decision to bring it forward.

The late kick-off has led to some schools announcing they will open later to help parents and students. Pubs and police are also bracing themselves for a busy night.

SPORT · UK
- 2

Prince Harry will travel to London without Meghan and their children for his upcoming trip, it's understood.

The plans reportedly changed after confirmation that the family would not receive taxpayer-funded security during their visit. The Duke of Sussex is expected to attend several engagements.

ROYAL · UK
- 3

Outgoing Prime Minister Keir Starmer has spoken for the first time about his 'intensely personal' decision to step down.

In a candid interview, Mr Starmer admitted it was 'really tough' to accept his political career was over. He also issued a warning to potential successor Andy Burnham.

POLITICS · UK
- 4

Brits are set for another heatwave, with temperatures forecast to exceed 30 degrees Celsius.

Forecasters predict this heatwave could last significantly longer than previous hot spells. Experts are advising people to stay hydrated and take precautions.

WEATHER · UK
- 5

The King has hailed a 'truly historic milestone' on the 250th anniversary of US independence.

His Majesty spoke of the strong relationship forged between the two countries. He said it was 'founded on friendship, trust and a belief in liberty'.

ROYAL · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Taylor Swift and Travis Kelce have officially tied the knot in a star-studded ceremony in New York City!**
Adam Sandler officiated the wedding, which saw several streets shut down in Midtown Manhattan. Fans gathered in huge numbers to celebrate the A-list couple.
ON AIR – What do you think of Adam Sandler officiating a wedding? Who would be your dream celebrity officiant?
CELEBRITY · NOW
- 2 The Specials' last ever album, taken from their 2019 performances at Coventry Cathedral, is set for release this month.**
The album is being hailed as a 'fitting tribute' to the late Terry Hall, the band's iconic frontman. It promises to be a poignant release for fans.
ON AIR – Are you a fan of The Specials? What's your favourite memory or song from the band?
MUSIC · SOON
- 3 A new Reggae walk of fame has been launched in Harlesden, celebrating the area's rich reggae heritage and Windrush pioneers.**
The trail in north-west London honours the significant contributions of artists and community figures. It aims to educate and inspire future generations.
ON AIR – What other genres or cultural movements do you think deserve their own walk of fame in the UK?
CULTURE · NOW
- 4 Stormtroopers are regularly patrolling the beaches of a seaside town near Blackpool, much to the delight of Star Wars fans.**
It's a yearly gathering for fans of the Star Wars prequel 'Andor', which used the location for filming. This unique event draws enthusiasts from all over.
ON AIR – If you could visit a real-life filming location, which one would it be and why?
FILM · SOON
- 5 The Grammy Awards are expanding their categories, adding new ones for Asian Pop and Latin song.**
This move follows recent successes from artists like Bad Bunny and KPop Demon Hunters. It aims to better reflect the global diversity of popular music.
ON AIR – What do you think of the Grammys adding more categories? Is there a genre you think is still overlooked?
AWARDS · SOON

On the schedule

1

Mercedes' Kimi Antonelli has overtaken Lewis Hamilton to win an action-packed sprint race at the British Grand Prix.

The young driver's impressive performance at Silverstone has certainly turned heads. It sets up an intriguing main race for Sunday.

ON AIR – What a race! Do you think Antonelli is a future world champion? Could he challenge Hamilton this season?

F1 · UK

2

Second seed Elena Rybakina has been knocked out of Wimbledon, suffering a straight-set defeat to Elise Mertens.

Rybakina is the highest seed to fall in the tournament so far, creating a big upset. Her early exit opens up the draw significantly.

ON AIR – Who do you think now has the best chance to win the women's singles title at Wimbledon?

TENNIS · UK

3

Ireland have denied the Wallabies after a nail-biting finish in Sydney, claiming a comeback bonus-point win.

Replacement Australia fly-half Ben Donaldson missed a last-gasp penalty, allowing Ireland to snatch victory. It was an enthralling Nations Championship contest.

ON AIR – What a finish! Do you think that missed penalty will haunt the Wallabies for the rest of the tournament?

RUGBY · INTERNATIONAL

4

Novak Djokovic has made history at Wimbledon, equalling Roger Federer's record of 105 men's singles match wins.

Djokovic battled past Arthur Rinderknech to claim his latest piece of history. He continues to dominate the record books at SW19.

ON AIR – Is Djokovic the greatest men's tennis player of all time? What do you think of his incredible consistency?

TENNIS · UK

5

England's Will Jacks has removed 15-year-old Indian sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi in the second T20 at Old Trafford.

After hitting a couple of big sixes on his international debut, Sooryavanshi was stumped for 14. India fell to 50-1 against England.

ON AIR – A 15-year-old playing international cricket! What's the youngest you've seen someone achieve something incredible in sport?

CRICKET · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees people embracing 'micro-adventures' close to home.**
Instead of grand trips, individuals are finding joy in exploring local parks, woodlands, or simply discovering a new walking path within their own neighbourhood for a refreshed perspective.
- 2 The surprising popularity of 'slow living' podcasts is on the rise.**
Listeners are drawn to content that encourages mindfulness, reduces screen time, and promotes a more deliberate, unhurried approach to daily life, from cooking to crafting.
- 3 Research suggests that displaying 'personal artwork' in the home can significantly boost mood.**
Whether it's a child's drawing or an amateur painting, having unique, meaningful pieces on display creates a sense of warmth and individuality that store-bought decor often lacks.
- 4 A study highlights the 'comforting power of routine' in modern life.**
Even small, consistent daily habits, like a morning cup of tea or a specific evening ritual, provide a sense of stability and reduce feelings of overwhelm in an increasingly busy world.
- 5 The 'joy of rediscovering old hobbies' is bringing smiles to many.**
People are dusting off instruments, knitting needles, or model kits from their youth, finding immense satisfaction and a sense of nostalgic comfort in activities once loved.
- 6 Experts are noting a surge in interest for 'community gardening projects'.**
Shared green spaces are not only producing fresh produce but also fostering stronger neighbourhood bonds and providing a therapeutic outdoor activity for all ages.
- 7 A quirky survey reveals the secret satisfaction of 'perfectly organised cupboards'.**
Many admit to feeling a genuine sense of calm and achievement when kitchen pantries or linen closets are neatly arranged, even if no one else ever sees them.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with our houseplants, even if we know they can't understand us?

ANSWER: TALKING TO THEM, OFFERING ENCOURAGEMENT OR EVEN A LITTLE SCOLDING!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'lucky item' they absolutely have to take with them on holiday. What is it?

ANSWER: A SPECIFIC TRAVEL MUG, A FAVOURITE BOOK, OR EVEN A 'LUCKY' PAIR OF SOCKS!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you try a 'new flavour of crisps' that you've never had before, and it turns out to be an unexpected delight?

Has there ever been a time you stepped out of your usual snack routine and discovered a new favourite? What was it, and why did it surprise you?

- We all have those little 'shortcuts' we take to make a daily task just a little bit easier or quicker, don't we?

What's your go-to 'life hack' or clever trick that saves you time or effort in your everyday routine? Share your ingenious methods!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of owls is called a 'parliament'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that some types of fish can climb trees using their fins, especially after heavy rain?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£14 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£14 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's oldest known piece of chewing gum is 9,000 years old.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time: 1/100th of a second.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- There are more fake flamingos in the world than real ones.
- The deepest point in the Earth's oceans, the Mariana Trench, is deeper than Mount Everest is tall.
- A group of flamingos is called a 'flamboyance'.

On this day

Day 186 of the year, 179 days left in 2026. Today Bloody Thursday (International Longshore and Warehouse Union); Christian feast day: Anthony Maria Zaccaria, priest (died 1539); Christian feast day: Cyril and Methodius (a public holiday in Czech Republic and Slovakia); Christian feast day: Martha, mother of Simeon Stylites the Younger. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1929 — Katherine Helmond, American actress and director (died 2019)
- 1991 — Jason Dolley, American actor, musician and Twitch streamer
- 1982 — Dave Haywood, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1929 — Tony Lock, English cricketer (died 1995)
- 1963 — Edie Falco, American actress
- 1979 — Shane Filan, Irish singer-songwriter
- 1938 — Ronnie Self, American singer-songwriter (died 1981)
- 1964 — Ronald D. Moore, American screenwriter and producer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1984 — The United States Supreme Court gives its *United States v. Leon* decision providing a good-faith exception from the Fourth Amendment exclusionary rule against use of evidence obtained through defective warrants in criminal trials.
- 1973 — Juvénal Habyarimana seizes power over Rwanda in a coup d'état.
- 2016 — The Juno space probe arrives at Jupiter and begins a 20-month survey of the planet.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1999 — U.S. President Bill Clinton imposes trade and economic sanctions against the Taliban regime in Afghanistan.
- 1989 — Iran–Contra affair: Oliver North is sentenced by U.S. District Judge Gerhard A. Gesell to a three-year suspended prison term, two years probation, \$150,000 in fines and 1,200 hours community service. His convictions are later overturned.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1996 — Dolly the sheep becomes the first mammal cloned from an adult cell.

- 1994 — Jeff Bezos founds Amazon.
- 2006 — North Korea tests four short-range missiles, one medium-range missile and a long-range Taepodong-2. The long-range Taepodong-2 reportedly fails in mid-air over the Sea of Japan.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 187 of the year, 178 days left in 2026. Today The first day of the Festival of San Fermín, which lasts until July 14. (Pamplona); Christian feast day: Goar of Aquitaine; Christian feast day: Maria Goretti; Christian feast day: Blessed Mary Theresa Ledóchowska. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1976 — Rory Delap, English-Irish footballer
- 1940 — Jeannie Seely, Grammy Award-winning country music singer-songwriter and Grand Ole Opry member (died 2025)
- 1939 — Mary Peters, English-Irish pentathlete and shot putter
- 1949 — Phyllis Hyman, American singer-songwriter and actress (died 1995)
- 1970 — Inspectah Deck, American rapper and producer
- 1982 — Misty Upham, American actress (died 2014)
- 1998 — Comethazine, American rapper
- 1939 — Jet Harris, English bass player (died 2011)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1966 — Malawi becomes a republic, with Hastings Banda as its first President.
- 1975 — The Comoros declares independence from France.
- 1957 — Althea Gibson wins at the Wimbledon Championships, becoming the first black athlete to do so.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1966 — Malawi becomes a republic, with Hastings Banda as its first President.
- 2006 — The Nathu La pass between India and China, sealed during the Sino-Indian War, re-opens for trade after 44 years.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026		AUGUST 2026	
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn	FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off	FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU	FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day	FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW			
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites		
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot		
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2		
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)		
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW			
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller		
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)		

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)